Commands, who would be responsible for this coordination? As such, the Area HQ does not have any troops under command and has to bank on the forces given to it from the Corps as per SOP. This issue is particularly important since as per the Cantonment Act, it is the Army Commander in whom all authority rests.[17] This was particularly relevant in the context of the Maritime Theatre Command (MTC), which would have the whole of peninsular India to look after, but with the authority in respect of Cantonments resting with the Army Commander, Southern Command, who would become part of the LTC (W). There were neither any clear-cut options nor discrete solutions. Each and every aspect would have to be brainstormed time and again and the possible models refined with every iteration.

When Gen Rawat had first mentioned an Air Defence Command, he had thought of it as a functional command which would involve the merger of Raise–Train–Sustain functions of the Army and Air Force ground-based AD systems, of which the majority were with the Army. At first sight, it appeared eminently doable, which is what prompted him to give out an ambitious timeline. Later, the Air Force felt that AD Command should also have an operational role. This, in turn, would imply the allocation of air assets separately for this role, which went against their very philosophy. Ultimately, the Air Force felt that an AD Command was not required at all, whether functional or operational. Almost a year was lost in the bargain.

The Army model was presented in one of the DMA meetings in the second half of 2020. Although inputs had been sought from the Air Force, these had not been forthcoming and accordingly, the Army model presented was based on general knowledge. This model was objected to by the Air Force, who said they had not been consulted. Catch-22. Having said that, they were now obliged to share the required information.

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